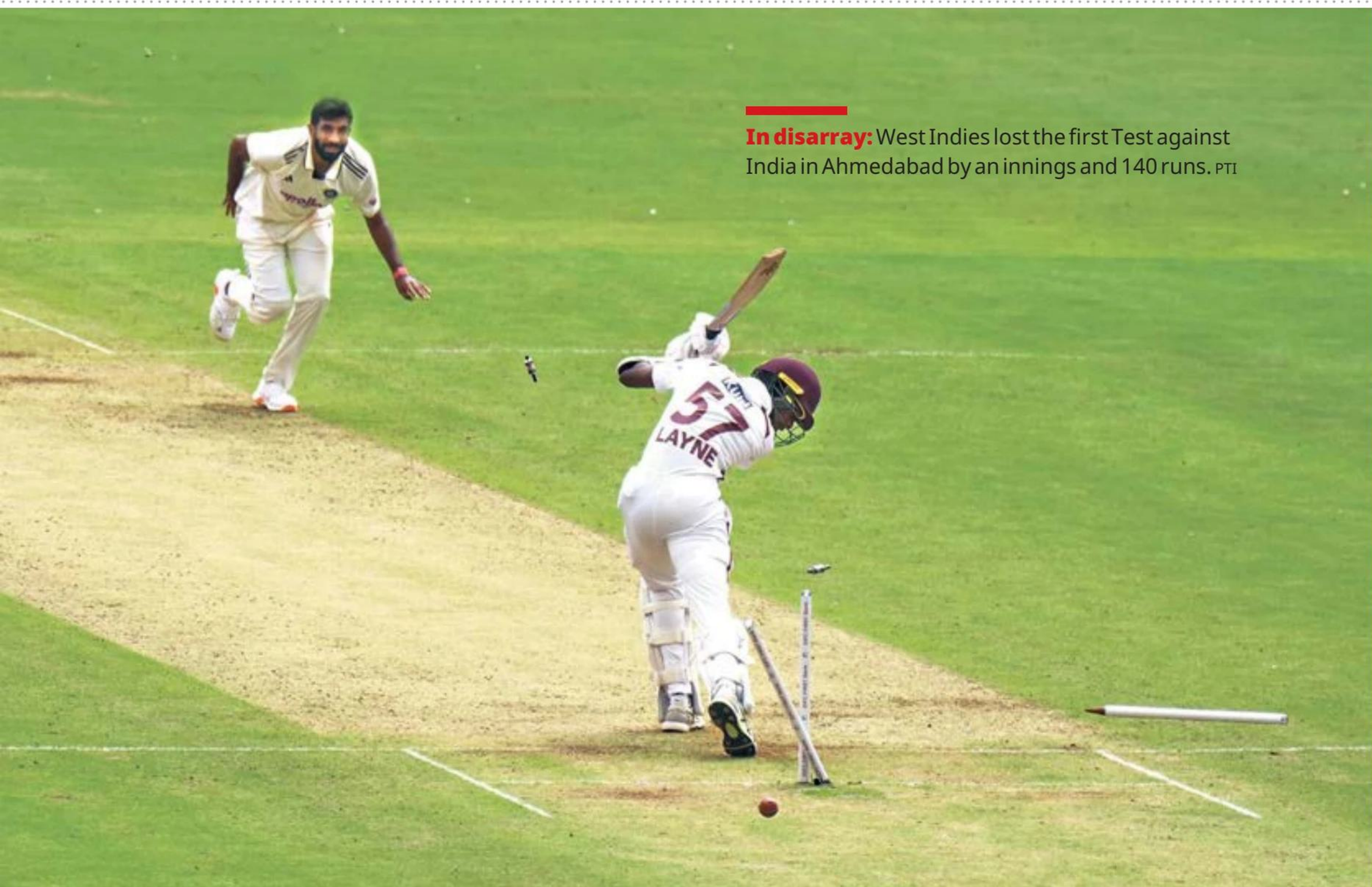




In disarray: West Indies lost the first Test against India in Ahmedabad by an innings and 140 runs. PTI

wanted to grit it out. And it wasn't even a pitch like last year, where the ball turned from day one. There was some turn on day three, but nowhere near as threatening as when Ravichandran Ashwin and Ravindra Jadeja made laughing stocks of some of the best batters in the game.

For a team that once boasted of the likes of the Three Ws, Rohan Kanhai, Seymour Nurse, Clive Lloyd, Gordon Greenidge and Desmond Haynes, to name just a few, there is simply nobody in this current team who looks like getting a million country miles close to them. Of

course, I haven't forgotten the incomparable Garfield Sobers, Viv Richards and the 'Prince of Trinidad', Brian Lara. They are geniuses born once in a century and were way above normal human beings.

The West Indies players are game-changers and impact-makers in the T20 format and are in great demand in the T20 leagues all over the world, but they don't play in the Test format, and that's a pity. It is not a pleasant sight to see the serious face of the usually jovial Daren Sammy, the current coach of the team, as he grapples with the

herculean task of getting his boys to stand up and fight it out. One of the most likeable and popular cricketers, who during his time as captain led the West Indies to two ICC T20 World Cup trophies, needs to bring that same zest and bounce-back ability to this West Indies Test side and make them competitive again, if not the destructive force of old.

If he can do that, not only will he bring a smile to the faces of the cricket-loving public in the Caribbean, but also to those all over the world for whom the West Indies were always the kings of the game.



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